

Cusp Xiangqi — Official Rulebook

Version: [0.1.0]

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1. Introduction

Cusp Xiangqi is a decisive xiangqi variant based on Freestyle Player-Balancing (FSPB). This variant aims to eliminate draws. By giving a color an edge with FSPB, the color must win and draw means loss for it. Then all other standard xiangqi rules apply.

This game is suitable for both human players and AI engines.

2. Components

- A standard **9×10 xiangqi board**.
- Standard xiangqi pieces for each player.

3. Initial setup

1. Standard xiangqi starting position.
 2. Determine who are **tentative Red player** and **tentative Black player** by mutual agreement or random choice.
 3. Piece Movement: All pieces (King, Guard, Bishop, Rook, Knight, Cannon, Pawn) move and capture exactly as they do in standard xiangqi, except in Decision Phase.
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4. Objective

- The goal of must-win color is to checkmate the opposing king. Draw means loss for the must-win color.
- The goal of the opposite color is to defend itself, and checkmate the opposing king if possible. Draw means win for it.
- The default must-win color is Red. If no one set up a fight-starting position when the game is over, draw means loss for the tentative Red player.

5. Gameplay Overview

It usually has three phases: Safe Move Phase, Decision Phase and Fight Phase. The first two phases are not to restrict players' moves. On the contrary, they are determined by players' moves in games. When a player makes a safe move, the game is in the Safe Move Phase. When a player decides to set up a fight-starting position, the game goes into the Decision Phase. After two colors are assigned to two players, the game enters the Fight Phase. The Fight Phase is the same as standard xiangqi. The flowchart of Cusp Xiangqi is shown in Figure 1.

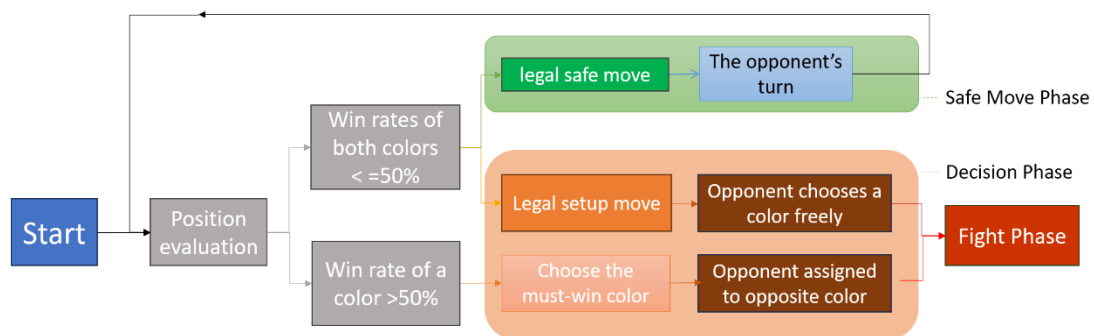


Figure 1. The flowchart of Cusp Xiangqi.

5.1 Positions

- **Safe position:** if win rates of both color of a position are below 50%, the position is a safe position. The previous player is safe, because their opponent can't choose the must-win color directly to win easily. Based on xiangqi engine Pikafish, the score of a safe position ranges from -1 to +1. The relation between safe position and optimal setup position are shown in Figure 2.

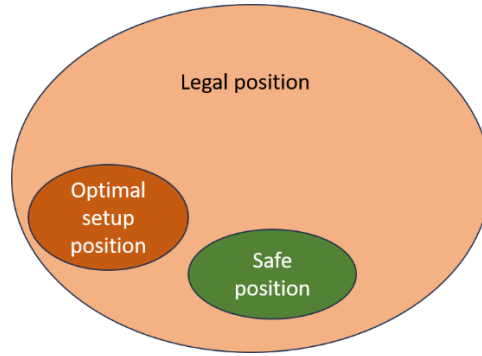


Figure 2. Positions in Cusp Chess.

- **Fight-starting position:** It is the starting position in the Fight Phase. There is only one fight starting position in a game. A player can set up a fight starting position by a legal setup move. If a player chooses the must-win color directly in a position, the position is the fight starting position. Each player has the right to set up a fight-starting position. However, this right can only be exercised once per game total. It is the tentative Red player's responsibility to set it up. if no one did it, draw means loss for the tentative Red player.
- **Cusp position or optimal setup position:** A cusp position's score is either around -1 or +1. They are optimal setup positions for fight-starting positions. The name of "cusp position" is from the evaluation function of typical engines as shown in Figure 3 and Figure 4.

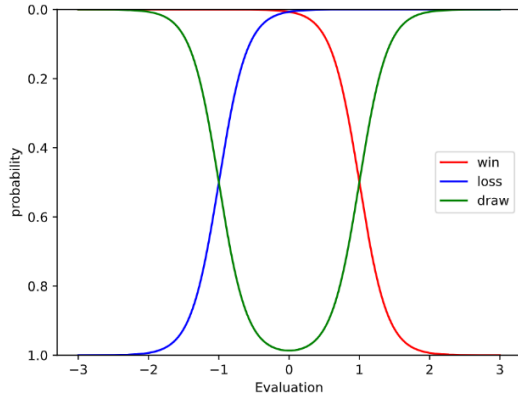


Figure 3. Evaluation curves.

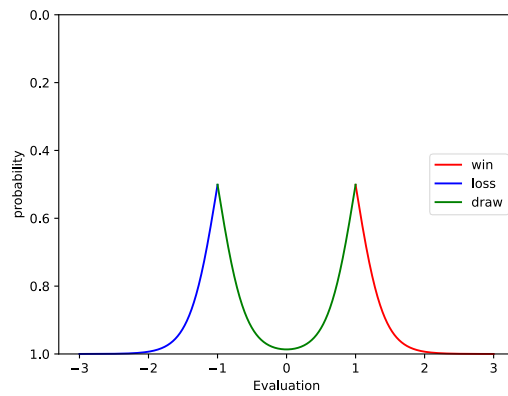


Figure 4. Cusp positions in an evaluation curve.

5.2 Moves

- **Legal move:** In Cusp Xiangqi, there are three types of legal moves for three phases respectively: legal safe moves, legal setup moves, and legal fight moves. The legal safe move and legal fight move are the same as legal moves in standard xiangqi. Legal setup move includes legal safe move and one-free move. All the moves in Safe Move and Decision Phases are shown in Figure 5.
- **Optimal safe move:** They are legal safe moves that can create safe positions in the Safe Move Phase. Usually there are multiple optimal safe move options for each position.

- **Setup move:** A legal move in Decision Phase is a set up move. It is used to set up a fight-starting position. For more information, please refer to Section 6.
- **Optimal setup move:** An optimal setup move can create an optimal setup position.
- **One-Free move:** All moves that are illegal in standard xiangqi designed to set up fight starting positions are One-Free moves. They are legal setup moves but not legal safe moves. There are two modes of One-Free move: Human-Level-Mode and Engine-Test-Mode. Human-level-Mode can create sufficient good fight-starting positions while won't overwhelm human players. Engine-Test-Mode can create much more good fight-starting positions, but not suitable for human players. For more information, please refer to Section 6.
- **Direct-choice move:** A player can choose a color directly after their opponent's safe move. But they can't make a move before the selection and can only choose the must-win color. They also can't set the side to move. Direct-choice move can be seen as a special setup move in the Decision Phase.

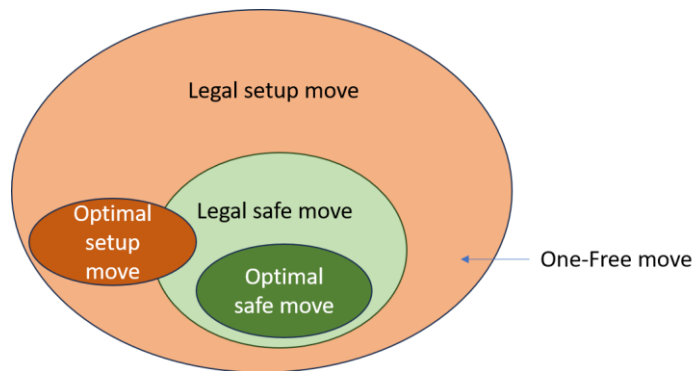


Figure 5. Moves in Safe Move Phase and Decision Phase.

5.3 Safe Move Phase

When a player makes a legal safe move, they need to specify whether they want to set up a fight-starting position or not, because a legal safe move is also a legal setup move.

If a player doesn't want to set up a fight-starting position now, they can make an optimal safe move to make the position balanced: $-1 < \text{position score} < 1$. If a player didn't make an optimal safe move and didn't set up a fight starting position, it is possible their opponent will choose the advantaged color directly because now the position is unbalanced and the advantaged color can win.

If a player is checked, the player can either resolve the check, or make a setup move, or choose a must-win color directly.

It is possible that no Safe Move Phase in a game. At the first move, a tentative Red player can choose a color directly or set up a fight-starting position and let his/her opponent to choose a color.

5.4 Decision Phase

A player can choose a color directly on their turn, if they didn't make a move, but they must choose the must-win color. Then their opponent is assigned to the opposite color automatically. Then the game goes into the Fight Phase.

A player can set up a fight-starting position by a legal setup move on their turn. When a player sets up a fight-starting position, the color-to-move and must-win color must also be specified. Then, his/her opponent must choose a color, which can be the must-win color or the opposite color. After a player chose a color, the opponent's color is fixed too. The game goes into Fight Phase.

5.5 Fight Phase

Now two colors are set. The two players must find the best moves. All standard xiangqi rules apply, except draw means loss for the must-win color.

5.6 Score Visualization of Three Phases

5.6.1 Same Move Phase and Decision Phase

300 games were played between two Pikafish-20260102. If a game's result was clear, the game was stop to reduce test time. The score lines in the Safe Move and Decision Phases are shown in Figure 6. The fight starting positions of the score lines are aligned as shown in Figure 7.

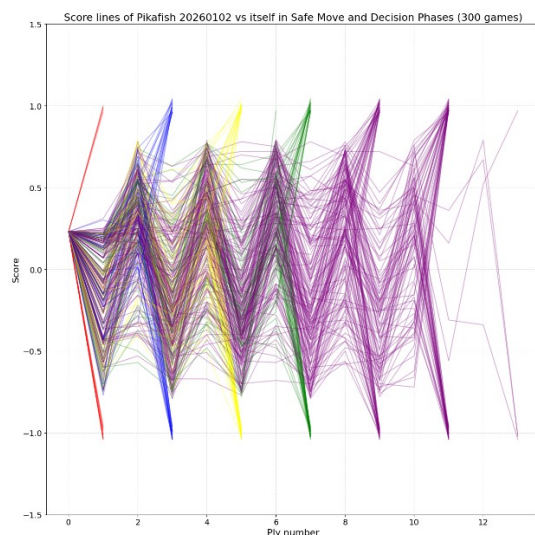


Figure 6. Score lines in Safe Move Phase and Decision Phase.
Phase and Decision Phase.

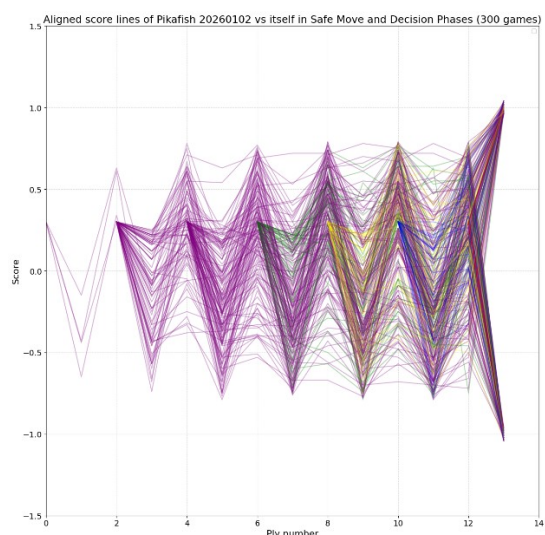


Figure 7. Aligned score lines in Safe Move
Move

5.6.2 All Three Phases

Aligned score lines of the Safe Move and Decision Phases with following 27 moves in the Fight Phase are shown in Figure 8 (only Stockfish 17.1's score lines in the Fight Phase). Aligned score lines of the 300 games are shown in Figure 9 (only Stockfish 17.1's score lines in the Fight Phase).

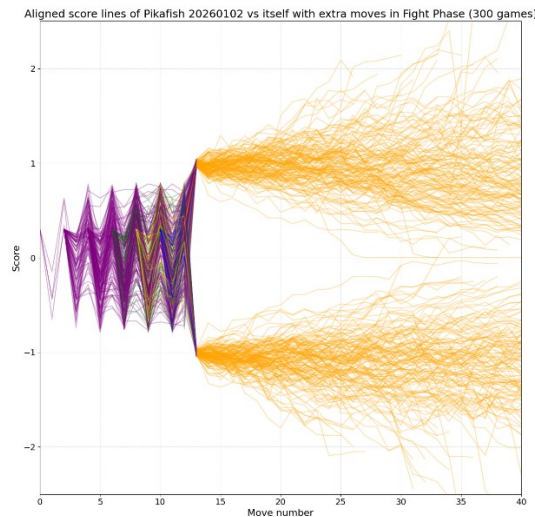


Figure 8. Aligned score lines with extra moves in Fight Phase.

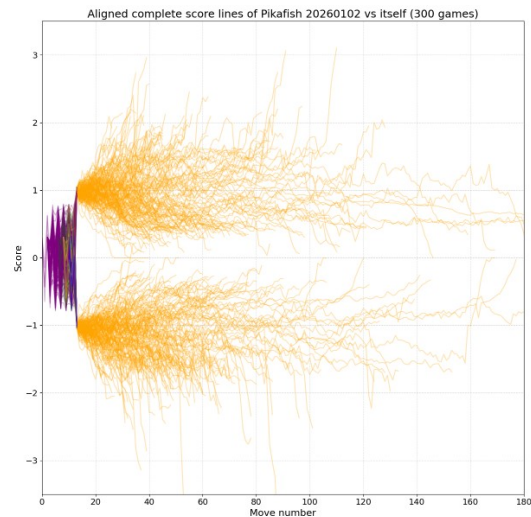


Figure 9. Aligned complete score lines.

6. Special Mechanics: “The Fight-Starting Position Setup Rules”

6.1 Legal setup move

Legal setup moves are legal moves in Decision Phase. They include legal safe moves and One-Free moves.

6.2 One-Free move

One-Free move is illegal in standard xiangqi. It is designed to create more good fight-starting positions in Cusp Xiangqi by relocating at most one piece. There are two modes for One-Free move in Cusp Xiangqi: Human-Level-Mode and Engine-Test-Mode.

6.3 Human-Level-Mode of One-Free move

- A player can make no move.
- A player can make an illegal move by relocating one of their own pawns onto a vacant square in the opponent's half board.
- A player can remove one piece from the board, including his/her opponent's piece, except the two kings.
- A player can't move the opponent's pieces.
- If a color sets up a fight-starting position to let the opponent choose a color, the opposite color automatically becomes the side to move in Fight Phase. For example, a tentative Red player set up a fight-starting position to let tentative Black player choose a color. In the fight-starting position, the side to move must be Black.
- If a player chooses a must-win color directly, the side to move in the position doesn't change. For example, if a tentative Red player chose a color directly, in the fight starting position the Red side is to move.
- All moves in Human-Level-Mode can't break the rules in 6.5.
- Human-Level-Mode is enough for human players and engines. Rules of Human-Level-Mode can be refined if necessary. The goal is to maximize the good fight starting position options for most safe positions while minimize the number of legal setup move options.

6.4 Engine-Test-Mode of One-Free move

- All moves in Human-Level-Mode in 6.3.
- A player can relocate a piece of any color to any square (either empty or occupied).
- A player can set the side to move freely when setting up a fight-starting position.
- All moves in Engine-Test-Mode can't break the rules in 6.5.
- Engine-Test-Mode can create much more good fight-starting positions, compared to Human-Level-Mode. It is not suitable for human players.

6.5 Forbidden moves and positions

- Neither color can be checkmated.
- The side to move can't be checking the opposite color.
- Both kings can not be removed.
- Moving more than one piece is not allowed, except a legal castling.

6.6 Legal moves if they don't break rules in 6.5

- A player can setup a fight-starting position when a color is checked.

7. Endgame and Victory Conditions

- If the must-win color checkmates the opponent, it wins. Otherwise, it loses the game. Draw means loss for the must-win color.
- If the must-win color is not set up in a game, Red is the must-win color by default. Draw means loss for the tentative Red player, because it is the tentative Red player's responsibility to set up a fight-starting position.

8. Notation System

All moves are recorded using Standard Algebraic Notation (SAN), except in Decision Phase. The notation system is designed to be Redundant on purpose. It is clear and intuitive.

All notations in Decision Phase start with "CX", which means "Cusp Xiangqi". The notation in the Decision Phase has two lines at most. If a player chooses a color directly, it has only one line.

There are four different notations in the Decision Phase:

- Move a piece. For example, in the notation "CX {RS e0e1 BWBN} {0.91}", "RS e0e1 BWBN" means tentative Red (R) player set (S) up a fight-starting position by moving a piece from e0 to e1. "BW" means the Black (B) color must win (W). "BN" means the Black (B) color moves next (N). {0.91} is the position score calculated by tentative Red player. Because it is 0.91 for Black, it is reasonable for the tentative Red player to set Black must win.
- Remove a piece. For example, in the notation "CX {RS f0xx BWBN} {0.92}", "RS f0xx" means tentative Red player set up a fight-starting position by removing a piece at f0 from the xiangqi board. "BW" means the Black color must win, and "BN" means the Black color moves next. The position score is 0.92 for the Black, that is why Black must win.
- Choose a color when the opponent set up a fight-starting Position. For example, in the notation "CX {BCBW} {1.08}", After tentative Red player set up a fight-starting Position, "BCB" means tentative Black player chose Black color. "BW" means that Black must win and draw means win for Red. {1.08} is the position score calculated by the tentative Black player. Because the position score was 1.08 for Black, then the tentative Black player thought the win rate of Black is over 50%. Choosing Black is a reasonable choice here.

- Choose a color directly. For example, in the notation “CX {BC none BWBN} {1.15}”, “BC” means tentative Black player chose a color directly. "none" means the player can't make a move when choosing a color directly. “BW” means the Black color must win. Here we know the tentative Black player can only choose Black color. His/her opponent will be the Red color. “BN” means the Black color moves next. The position score is 1.15 for Black, which means the win rate of Black is over 50%. That is also why the player chose Black directly.

9. Examples of Play

Here are four games played by xiangqi engine Pikafish 20260102 and Pikafish 20250623. Pikafish 20260102 is the tentative Red player. When the result of a game was clear, an adjudicator engine may stop the game to save test time.

A, moving a piece at starting position to set up a fight-starting Position. Pikafish 20260102 won as Red, because draw means loss for Black.

- | | |
|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1. CX {RS e0e1 BWBN} {0.91} | 18. f4e6 {-0.69} c7e6 {0.72} |
| 2. CX {BCBW} {1.08} | 19. e4e7 {-0.67} g9e7 {0.88} |
| 3. ... h7e7 {1.04} | 20. a2a6 {-0.62} e6d4 {0.87} |
| 4. h0g2 {-0.98} h9g7 {1.14} | 21. c2e1 {-0.7} c5c4 {0.91} |
| 5. i0h0 {-0.95} i9h9 {1.12} | 22. e3e4 {-0.72} a7c7 {0.92} |
| 6. e1e0 {-0.99} c6c5 {1.14} | 23. c1d1 {-0.77} c7d7 {0.91} |
| 7. g3g4 {-1.02} b9c7 {0.99} | 24. d1c1 {-0.85} c4c3 {0.88} |
| 8. b0c2 {-0.92} h9h3 {1.05} | 25. e1f3 {-0.74} d4e6 {0.87} |
| 9. g2f4 {-1.05} b7a7 {1.03} | 26. f3d2 {-0.7} b3a3 {0.89} |
| 10. a0a1 {-0.88} a9b9 {1.0} | 27. a6b6 {-0.6} c3d3 {0.84} |
| 11. h0h1 {-0.86} e6e5 {0.89} | 28. c1c6 {-0.55} e6c5 {0.94} |
| 12. h2e2 {-0.85} h3g3 {0.95} | 29. b6g6 {-0.54} c5e4 {0.72} |
| 13. a1g1 {-0.81} g3g1 {0.85} | 30. d2f1 {-0.56} a3a4 {0.78} |
| 14. h1g1 {-0.8} e5e4 {0.78} | 31. g6h6 {-0.48} e7g9 {0.65} |
| 15. e2e4 {-0.75} d9e8 {0.86} | 32. c6c9 {-0.46} e8d9 {0.6} |
| 16. b2a2 {-0.74} b9b3 {0.79} | 33. h6h2 {-0.43} d7e7 {0.59} |
| 17. g1c1 {-0.74} g7e6 {0.66} | 34. h2e2 {-0.4} d3e3 {0.57} |

35. f1e3 {-0.35} e7e3 {0.52}

36. e2e4 {-0.3} a4e4 {0.51}

37. c9c6 {-0.36} e3a3 {0.48}

38. c0e2 {-0.32} a3a0 {0.52}

39. d0e1 {-0.3} e4b4 {0.49}

40. e0d0 {-0.32} b4b0 {0.48}

41. result {engine adjudicator 1/2-1/2}

B, moving a piece to set up a fight-starting Position. Pikafish 20260102 won as Red, because draw means win for Red.

1. h2e2 {0.23} b9c7 {-0.45}

2. CX {RS e2h2 BWBN} {0.92}

3. CX {BCBW} {1.04}

4. ... c6c5 {0.99}

5. g3g4 {-0.89} h7e7 {1.05}

6. h0g2 {-0.96} h9g7 {1.07}

7. i0h0 {-0.95} i9h9 {1.12}

8. c0e2 {-1.01} h9h3 {1.08}

9. d0e1 {-1.09} c7d5 {1.17}

10. h2i2 {-1.14} h3g3 {1.14}

11. b2d2 {-1.13} a9a7 {1.07}

12. b0c2 {-0.97} b7d7 {1.12}

13. d2d7 {-1.04} a7d7 {1.1}

14. a0d0 {-1.12} g6g5 {1.09}

15. g2i1 {-0.98} g3g1 {1.07}

16. g4g5 {-0.74} g1i1 {0.94}

17. g5g6 {-0.69} g7e8 {0.9}

18. h0h5 {-0.69} e8c7 {0.93}

19. i2i6 {-0.7} i1i3 {0.94}

20. i6i5 {-0.65} d5f4 {0.88}

21. d0d7 {-0.62} f4h5 {0.83}

22. i5c5 {-0.65} c7b5 {0.76}

23. d7b7 {-0.7} b5c3 {0.83}

24. b7b3 {-0.74} c9a7 {0.77}

25. c5g5 {-0.69} g9i7 {0.77}

26. b3c3 {-0.65} i7g5 {0.78}

27. c3c6 {-0.67} g5i7 {0.8}

28. c6e6 {-0.68} i7g9 {0.8}

29. c2b4 {-0.61} h5f4 {0.73}

30. e6e4 {-0.61} f4g6 {0.74}

31. b4d5 {-0.57} e7e5 {0.76}

32. e4a4 {-0.6} a7c5 {0.71}

33. e3e4 {-0.63} e5e8 {0.66}

34. a4a6 {-0.59} g6h4 {0.6}

35. d5f6 {-0.54} e8f8 {0.59}

36. f6d7 {-0.52} f8d8 {0.62}

37. e2g4 {-0.48} g9e7 {0.55}

38. a6a8 {-0.3} i3i8 {0.5}

39. d7e5 {-0.29} h4i6 {0.52}

40. e5f7 {-0.34} d8f8 {0.49}

41. f7h6 {-0.38} i8h8 {0.54}

42. a8a6 {-0.32} i6h4 {0.46}

43. a3a4 {-0.42} f8e8 {0.49}

44. h6f7 {-0.45} h8f8 {0.51}

45. f7e5 {-0.44} f8f4 {0.53}

46. a6h6 {-0.43} h4g2 {0.55}

47. result {engine adjudicator 1/2-1/2}

C, removing a piece to set up a fight-starting Position. Pikafish 20260102 lost as Red.

- | | |
|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1. c0e2 {0.21} h7h6 {-0.84} | 28. d2d1 {-1.41} h1h6 {1.54} |
| 2. h2h5 {-0.16} b7b8 {-0.6} | 29. d1d6 {-1.5} h6h1 {1.57} |
| 3. CX {RS f0xx BWBN} {0.92} | 30. d6d1 {-1.54} h1h6 {1.63} |
| 4. CX {BCBW} {1.0} | 31. d0b0 {-1.57} f7f6 {1.66} |
| 5. ... g6g5 {1.05} | 32. b6b7 {-1.55} e7c9 {1.6} |
| 6. h5h4 {-0.99} h9g7 {1.08} | 33. d1d0 {-1.63} g9e7 {1.63} |
| 7. h0g2 {-0.99} b8a8 {1.05} | 34. b0b4 {-1.57} h6h1 {1.56} |
| 8. b0d1 {-1.0} c9e7 {1.07} | 35. d0d1 {-1.63} h1h3 {1.72} |
| 9. h4a4 {-0.83} a6a5 {0.96} | 36. d1d3 {-1.68} h3h1 {1.79} |
| 10. a4a8 {-0.87} a9a8 {0.97} | 37. d3d1 {-1.57} h1h3 {1.69} |
| 11. i0h0 {-0.95} i9h9 {1.01} | 38. d1d0 {-1.58} e5c5 {1.74} |
| 12. h0h4 {-0.88} g7f5 {1.03} | 39. b4i4 {-1.5} c5a5 {1.56} |
| 13. a3a4 {-0.92} a5a4 {1.14} | 40. i4i6 {-1.55} f6f7 {1.77} |
| 14. a0a4 {-1.08} a8d8 {1.26} | 41. b7b4 {-1.54} a7c6 {1.65} |
| 15. d1f0 {-1.23} h9h8 {1.21} | 42. b4c4 {-1.68} c6d4 {1.95} |
| 16. d0e1 {-1.3} d8d1 {1.28} | 43. e3e4 {-1.63} h3g3 {1.51} |
| 17. a4a0 {-1.32} c6c5 {1.41} | 44. i6i5 {-1.61} e7g5 {1.57} |
| 18. g3g4 {-1.28} g5g4 {1.42} | 45. i5i9 {-1.61} f7f9 {1.66} |
| 19. h4g4 {-1.27} h6f6 {1.53} | 46. i9h9 {-1.73} g3d3 {1.66} |
| 20. a0d0 {-1.29} d1b1 {1.72} | 47. d0d4 {-1.52} d3d1 {1.71} |
| 21. b2d2 {-1.62} f9e8 {1.62} | 48. c4c0 {-1.7} d1d4 {1.65} |
| 22. c3c4 {-1.37} c5c4 {1.83} | 49. c0c9 {-1.6} a5a3 {1.63} |
| 23. g4c4 {-1.51} b9a7 {1.95} | 50. c9c1 {-1.65} a3g3 {1.57} |
| 24. c4c0 {-1.66} b1b5 {1.43} | 51. e2c0 {-1.73} d4e4 {1.56} |
| 25. c0b0 {-1.59} b5e5 {1.39} | 52. c1c5 {-1.65} e6e5 {1.71} |
| 26. b0b7 {-1.26} f6f7 {1.51} | 53. h9g9 {-1.66} g3f3 {1.54} |
| 27. b7b6 {-1.34} h8h1 {1.41} | 54. g9g5 {-1.71} f3f1 {1.82} |

55. c0e2 {-1.92} e8f7 {1.71}
56. e2c0 {-1.9} d9e8 {1.71}
57. c5c2 {-1.87} e4d4 {1.87}
58. c2f2 {-1.65} f1f2 {1.95}
59. e1f2 {-1.77} e5e4 {1.65}
60. f2e1 {-1.74} e4e3 {1.64}
61. g0e2 {-1.73} e3f3 {1.61}
62. f0h1 {-1.81} e9d9 {1.67}
63. i3i4 {-1.88} d4i4 {1.69}
64. g2i3 {-1.97} i4h4 {1.71}
65. h1f0 {-1.82} h4d4 {1.69}
66. f0g2 {-1.76} f3g3 {1.74}
67. g2f0 {-1.88} d9d8 {1.81}
68. i3g4 {-1.72} f9b9 {1.77}
69. c0a2 {-1.72} d4d5 {1.86}
70. e2c4 {-1.81} b9e9 {1.96}
71. f0e2 {-1.87} g3f3 {1.85}
72. e0f0 {-1.89} f3e3 {1.94}
73. e2g1 {-1.88} e9f9 {1.8}
74. f0e0 {-1.75} d5d1 {2.0}
75. c4e2 {-1.95} d1d4 {2.0}
76. g5g6 {-2.11} f9e9 {2.09}
77. a2c4 {-2.3} d4d3 {2.33}
78. e2c0 {-2.43} e3f3 {2.44}
79. g1e2 {-2.3} f5h4 {2.5}
80. g6b6 {-2.4} d3d1 {2.47}
81. b6b2 {-2.63} e8f9 {2.62}
82. g4e5 {-2.71} f3f2 {2.56}
83. e5c6 {-2.67} d8d9 {2.52}
84. c6e7 {-2.66} f9e8 {2.59}
85. e7c8 {-2.71} f2e2 {2.68}
86. c4e2 {-2.73} d9d8 {2.74}
87. c8a7 {-2.63} d1c1 {2.69}
88. b2b6 {-2.72} e8d7 {2.54}
89. e0d0 {-2.84} d8d9 {2.75}
90. a7c6 {-2.82} h4g2 {2.71}
91. c6b8 {-2.71} c1c8 {2.81}
92. e1f2 {-2.75} f7e8 {2.75}
93. b6b4 {-2.8} e9f9 {2.72}
94. b8a6 {-2.72} c8c3 {2.95}
95. b4e4 {-2.8} d9e9 {2.99}
96. a6b8 {-2.91} c3c7 {3.05}
97. b8a6 {-3.03} c7c6 {3.11}
98. a6b8 {-3.11} c6c7 {3.18}
99. e4g4 {-3.19} g2h0 {3.25}
100. g4b4 {-3.24} h0f1 {3.62}
101. f2e1 {-3.49} c7c3 {3.78}
102. b4d4 {-3.66} f1h2 {3.98}
103. b8d7 {-4.05} e8d7 {4.53}
104. d4d7 {-4.56} c3e3 {4.84}
105. d0e0 {-4.75} h2f3 {5.03}
106. d7d2 {-5.12} f3g1 {5.78}
107. e0d0 {-5.08} f9i9 {5.82}
108. d2d7 {-5.23} e3h3 {6.09}
109. d7e7 {-5.84} e9f9 {7.74}
110. e7f7 {-6.27} f9e9 {13.76}
111. f7e7 {-6.83} e9f9 {99.72}
112. e7f7 {-8.33}

113. result {0-1}

D, choosing a color directly to set up a fight-starting Position. Pikafish 20260102 won as Red, because draw means loss for Black.

- | | |
|------------------------------|---|
| 1. b2b1 {-0.38} b7a7 {-0.04} | 25. i4i0 {-1.04} d9e8 {1.06} |
| 2. f0e1 {-0.28} a7f7 {-0.41} | 26. i0h0 {-1.01} g2g1 {1.12} |
| 3. e0f0 {-1.07} | 27. c6d6 {-0.94} b5d5 {1.03} |
| 4. CX {BC none BWBN} {1.15} | 28. d6b6 {-1.02} c7b5 {1.12} |
| 5. ... g6g5 {1.28} | 29. h6h5 {-0.96} d5d1 {0.98} |
| 6. f0e0 {-1.01} h9g7 {1.22} | 30. h0h2 {-0.65} b5d4 {0.83} |
| 7. a0a2 {-1.09} b9c7 {1.2} | 31. c2d4 {-0.52} d1d4 {0.7} |
| 8. a2b2 {-1.07} h7i7 {1.22} | 32. h5h4 {-0.56} e6e5 {0.66} |
| 9. h2f2 {-1.03} i9h9 {1.17} | 33. b6b1 {-0.55} d4d1 {0.69} |
| 10. b2b4 {-0.98} i6i5 {1.15} | 34. b1b5 {-0.68} d1d5 {0.62} |
| 11. h0g2 {-0.97} i5i4 {1.08} | 35. b5b1 {-0.62} d5d1 {0.74} |
| 12. i0h0 {-0.91} h9h0 {1.04} | 36. b1b2 {-0.55} h7g5 {0.7} |
| 13. g2h0 {-0.91} i4i3 {0.97} | 37. h4g4 {-0.55} g9i7 {0.68} |
| 14. g3g4 {-0.78} g7i6 {1.1} | 38. h2g2 {-0.42} g1h1 {0.68} |
| 15. b1c1 {-0.96} g5g4 {1.01} | 39. b2b5 {-0.43} e5e4 {0.59} |
| 16. b4g4 {-1.01} c9e7 {1.1} | 40. e3e4 {-0.36} g5e4 {0.53} |
| 17. c1c6 {-0.89} i6g5 {1.08} | 41. g4f4 {-0.42} e7g5 {0.52} |
| 18. f2f6 {-0.91} g5h7 {1.09} | 42. b5b4 {-0.37} e4c3 {0.47} |
| 19. f6h6 {-0.99} a9b9 {1.09} | 43. f4f1 {-0.33} d1d3 {0.48} |
| 20. b0c2 {-1.04} b9b5 {1.05} | 44. b4b3 {-0.32} d3d5 {0.53} |
| 21. g0e2 {-1.08} i3h3 {1.08} | 45. g2g3 {-0.3} f7c7 {0.44} |
| 22. c3c4 {-1.04} i7i0 {1.11} | 46. b3b6 {-0.31} d5d6 {0.39} |
| 23. h0g2 {-0.96} h3h2 {0.99} | 47. b6b5 {-0.33} d6d5 {0.38} |
| 24. g4i4 {-1.12} h2g2 {1.2} | 48. result {engine adjudicator 1/2-1/2} |
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10. Reference

Cusp Xiangqi GUI python code: <https://github.com/hahachess2025/cuspxiangqi>

Cusp Chess GUI python code: <https://github.com/hahachess2025/cuspchess>

Engine games played with the GUI on Youtube:

<https://www.youtube.com/@hahachess>

Reddit community: <https://www.reddit.com/r/CuspChess>

For more details about the framework Freestyle Player-Balancing, please check my preprint paper on zenodo. The title is *Freestyle Player-Balancing: A Novel Flexible Framework for Addressing Game Balance and Opening Memorization in Decisive, Two-Player, Perfect-Information, Turn-Based Games*.

<https://zenodo.org/records/21687566>.

11. Licensing and Contact

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